BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha®
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|| Shri Swaminarayano Vijayate ||

Kitchen Lead Seva Guidelines

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1. Objective

1.1. The objective of this document is:

1.1.1. to assist with better planning, coordination and execution of various Satsang development related activities

1.1.2. to have a uniform and more structured approach while performing seva

1.1.3. to provide further information about high level roles & responsibilities and streamline various processes

1.1.4. to clarify any doubts or misconceptions during seva

1.1.5. to build, maintain and increase Samp-Suhradbhav-Ekta

1.1.6. to earn Satpurush's rajipo

2. Vimarsh & Communication

2.1. Must attend monthly Pramukh Vimarsh

2.2. Any decisions discussed during Pramukh Vimarsh, Lead to discuss and explain to respective Team Members to start planning for the project / event

2.3. Keep Services Admin in loop (FYI) for any action item and provide any updates in Pramukh Vimarsh

2.4. Keep Servies Admin in loop (FYI) for any guidance received from P. Santo and National Kitchen Team

2.5. Get help from Mahila Kitchen Lead and Cooking Leads (both male and female) to prepare 3 months Prasad menu in advance as per national guidelines and get it reviewed from P. Santo while keeping Services Admin (both male and female) in loop

2.6. Must attend any meetings organised by National Kitchen Team to get necessary guidance and information regarding better Kitchen seva planning and execution

2.7. If for any genuine reason, Kitchen Lead is unable to attend a national meeting, Kitchen Lead must discuss with Services Admin to nominate another volunteer from local Kitchen Team to attend the meeting on his behalf and get updates from that volunteer after the meeting and take necessary actions based on that meeting while keeping Services Admin in loop.

2.8. For any assistance or guidance required for cooking any Prasad (e.g. recipe), Kitchen Lead to contact National Kitchen Team.

2.9. Work with Shayona Lead for any Shayona Sweets orders and work with Catering & Hall Hire Lead for any Catering orders if required

2.10. Mahila Facilities & Services Admin to support Kitchen Lead (Male) to prepare quarterly Prasad menu and Shayona (e.g. Sweets) and Catering cooking seva.
2.11. If required, Kitchen Lead to provide any assistance for Mandir Thakorji Thal Seva and P. Sant Bhojan Seva.
2.12. Kitchen Lead to keep Services Admin (both male & female) in loop for any special event related kitchen seva. Recurring day-to-day Kitchen related seva can be communicated and coordinated directly with Mahila Kitchen Lead.

3. Team Development

3.1. Allocate seva to Kitchen volunteers as per the seva structure provided by National Kitchen Team and ensure seva is performed as per the structure.
3.2. Prepare Cooking Teams for both male and female and set a roster to share seva load. This will help to increase new skilled volunteers and will also ensure that volunteers are not overloaded.
3.3. If required and possible, have separate male and female teams for Shayona and Catering cooking along with Ravisabha Teams so that seva load is efficiently distributed.
3.4. Prepare Serving and Kitchen Cleaning / Wind Up Teams for male and set a roster.
3.5. Lead by example by remaining physically present during seva and provide necessary support and build rapport with team members.
3.6. Look for new potential volunteers during Prasad time.
3.7. Encourage his respective Team Members' Growth / Development and build Samp amongst volunteers as per Bapa's ruchi.
3.8. Appreciate any constructive ideas received from Team members and then discuss with Services Admin, Mandir / Centre Coordinator (CO) and further with National Kitchen Team and P. Santo if required before any implementation.
3.9. Appreciate Team Members' good qualities during seva (commitment, sincerity, dedication, exceptional seva, etc.) in front of P. Santo and other volunteers in Vimarsh. This will encourage volunteers to perform their seva better.
3.10. Organise monthly Kitchen Vimarsh with all Kitchen Team members while keeping Services Admin in loop (FYI).
3.11. Send minutes to all members (present & absent) within 1 day after the Vimarsh.

4. Financial Expenses Process

4.1. Can authorise any new expenses up to $150 at his own discretion.
4.2. Discuss and get pre-authorisation from Services Admin for any expense incurred by his respective Team and submit the expense claim voucher along with supporting invoices as per Accounting Process so the Accounts Team can process any payments on time (1 week).

4.3. Already approved recurring expenses (e.g. Ravisabha Prasad grocery) need not require any pre-authorisation every time.
4.4. For any requirements to purchase any kitchen related big utensils, appliances, etc. discuss with National Kitchen Team and P. Santo if required.
4.5. Prepare business proposal plan along with 3 accompanying quotes to submit to the board (if required), send the plan to CO while keeping Services Admin in loop.
4.6. Only incur purchase once a formal approval is received from the board.
4.7. Ensure that a proper tax invoice with ABN is obtained for any purchase as per the Accounts process.
4.8. Prepare Kitchen related budget based on National Year Planner by discussing with CO and Accounts Admin (to obtain previous year's actuals) while keeping Services Admin in loop.

5. Seva Changes and New Appointment

5.1. Discuss any Team Member seva changes with Services Admin and further with CO and Local Vicharan P. Santo if required and then send an appreciation message for old volunteer and welcome message for new volunteer in respective team members' seva group and only after that make any changes in the group.

6. Conflict Resolution

6.1. For any conflicts or issues amongst Team Members and with other departments, Kitchen Lead to discuss with Services Admin to try to build and maintain Samp and if required discuss with CO / Local Vicharan P. Santo before making any decision.

7. Other Notes

7.1. Provide necessary support to other wings / teams / events for their Prasad requirement, such as BKY, iBKY, Sports, Outing, Shibir, Annakut, Jamo Ne Jamadu, Karyakar Goshthi with P. Santo at Mandir, during Volunteer Seva, COPR Guests, Chhatralay (where applicable), etc.
7.2. Coordinate with Accounts Team to prepare and supply Prasad Boxes for donors.
7.3. Support and plan well for any Catering and Shayona (e.g. sweets) related requirements while keeping respective Catering Lead and Shayona Lead and Services Admin in loop
7.4. Assist with price determination for Catering and Shayona (e.g. sweets) to respective Catering and Shayona Lead while keeping Services Admin in loop.
7.5. Use kitchen software provided by National Kitchen Team to regularly update and keep track of stocktake on a monthly basis.
7.6. Ensure the following national Prasad guidelines are followed:
    7.6.1. Regular Sabha – 4 items
    7.6.2. Utsav Sabha – 6 items

7.6.3. Mahotsav Sabha – 8 items
7.6.4. Any Other Indoor / Outdoor Events – Discuss with P. Santo

7.7. For any Parasabha or Regional Sabha kitchen related utensils requirements, discuss with National Kitchen Team and provide any necessary support they may require.
7.8. Ensure all health & safety and local compliance requirements are satisfied all the time.
7.9. Ensure all the kitchen appliances are regularly checked and maintained well and keep a maintenance log.
7.10. Assist with any bhojan requirement for P. Sadguru Santo, Local Vicharan P. Santo and Pujari for Thakorji's Thal as and when required.
7.11. As per Param Pujya Tyagvallabh Swami's agna, plan any Kitchen seva during Ravisabha and other events in such a way that maximum volunteers can get Katha-Varta labh instead of engaging in seva in the kitchen.
7.12. Place a small Mandir in Kitchen and offer any food items prepared to Thakorji in that Mandir first.
7.13. For any grocery purchase, ensure to check ingredients and ensure that it only contains ingredients consumables by BAPS satsangis and consult National Kitchen Team if any doubts.
7.14. Ensure Prasad is distributed to any grocery and vegetables donors at regular intervals (e.g. after Annakut, Patotsav, Janmashtami, etc.) to maintain and increase relationship with those donors.
7.15. It is Kitchen Lead's responsibility to keep Services Admin in loop.
7.16. Guidelines and information provided in this document is not extensive. Additional guidelines and / or information will be provided through various formal and informal channels (written, through meetings, in person, over the phone or virtually) as and when deemed necessary under P. Santo and BAPS ANZ National Team's guidance.

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